

MINUTES OF PROCEEDINGS AT MONTHLY MEETING OF THE METROPOLITAN DISTRICT OF LIMERICK HELD IN THE COUNCIL CHAMBER, MERCHANT'S QUAY, LIMERICK AND ONLINE ON MONDAY, 10TH MARCH, 2025 at 9.45 A.M.

PRESENT IN THE CHAIR: Councillor K. O'Hanlon, Cathaoirleach

MEMBERS IN ATTENDANCE:

Councillors Beasley, Benson, Butler, Daly, Donoghue, Doyle, Gavan, Hartigan, Hickey-O'Mara, Kiely, Kilcoyne, Leddin, McSweeney, O'Sullivan, Pond, Reale, Secas, Slattery and Talukder.

OFFICIALS IN ATTENDANCE:

Director of Service, Environment, Climate Action and Shared Services (Mr. K. Lehane), Meetings Administrator (Ms. A. Foley), Senior Executive Officer, Metropolitan District of Limerick (Ms. S. Reidy), Administrative Officer, Property Management (Ms. T. Knox), Senior Engineer, Active Travel (Mr. S. McGlynn), Senior Executive Planner, Forward Planning (Ms. C. Brislane), Senior Executive Architect (Ms. G. McMahon), Executive Architectural Conservation Officer (Ms. S. O'Keeffe), Senior Engineer, Roads, Traffic and Cleansing (Mr. J. Gannon), Senior Executive Engineers, Roads, Traffic and Cleansing (Mr. M. Richardson and Mr. L. Browne), City and County Librarian (Mr. D. Brady), LCDC Chief Officer (Mr. S. O'Connor), Senior Engineer, Environment and Climate Action (Mr. A. Finn), Administrative Officer, Environment and Climate Action (Ms. S. Hourigan), Senior Executive Officer, Housing Support Services (Ms. M. Hayes), Administrative Officer, Housing Support Services (Ms. K. O'Grady), Assistant Staff Officer, Corporate Services and Governance (Ms. S. Carroll).

At the outset, the Cathaoirleach stated that the Ukrainian flag displayed in the Chamber was presented to him in Strasbourg in his role as President of AILG. He outlined that he will be signing a Friendship Agreement with the equivalent Association from Ukraine in the coming weeks.

1. Adoption of Minutes

Circulated, copy of draft Minutes of the Monthly Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick held on 17th February, 2025.

Proposed by Councillor McSweeney;

Seconded by Councillor Reale;

And Resolved:

"That the draft Minutes, as circulated, be taken as read and adopted and signed".

Councillor McSweeney referred to the Notice of Motion he brought to the December Metropolitan District Meeting in relation to Active Travel Schemes and the impact such schemes may have on emergency response times, and requested an update on the report that was being prepared.

The Senior Engineer, Active Travel informed the Members that a review of the current schemes had been completed. He confirmed that the report would be circulated to Elected Members and a Briefing would be arranged to discuss the outcome of the review.

2. Declaration of Interest

The Meetings Administrator stated that, in line with Part 15 of the Local Government Act, 2001, as amended, and the Code of Conduct, she was inviting those present to notify the Cathaoirleach of any declaration of interest in any item due for discussion at the Meeting. No such interests were declared.

3. Disposal of Land

- (a) Circulated, Report of the Head of Property Management dated 26th February, 2025, setting out proposals for Proposed Disposal of 121 Dalgaish Park, Moyross, Limerick for the consideration of acquiring 17 Pineview Gardens, Moyross, Limerick and the intention to bring a Section 183 Notice to Full Council in this regard, for approval.

The report, as circulated, was noted by Members.

- (b) Circulated, Report of the Head of Property Management dated 26th February, 2025, setting out proposals for Proposed Disposal of Roseville, O'Donoghue Avenue, Janesboro, Limerick for the consideration of acquiring 119 Mountain View, O'Malley Park, Limerick and the intention to bring a Section 183 Notice to Full Council in this regard, for approval.

The report, as circulated, was noted by Members.

4. Schedule of Municipal District Works for Metropolitan District of Limerick

Circulated, Report of the Director of Services dated 4th March, 2025, setting out the background to the preparation of a Schedule of Municipal District Works and including the Draft Schedule of Municipal District Works 2025 for the Metropolitan District of Limerick.

Proposed by Councillor McSweeney;

Seconded by Councillor Donoghue;

And Resolved:

“That the Schedule of Municipal District Works 2025 for the Metropolitan District of Limerick be adopted in accordance with Section 103A of the Local Government Act 2001 (as amended)”.

Members highlighted the need for more consultation with the Elected Members when preparing the Schedule of Municipal District Works. It was agreed that, going forward, workshops would be organised well in advance of drafting the Schedule, to include the Members input.

5. Housing Directorate

(a) Part 8 Procedure – Nos. 35–39 Nicholas Street, Limerick

Circulated, Report of the Senior Planner, Forward Planning, Public Realm and Heritage dated 4th March, 2025 and enclosed Mayor's Report dated 28th February, 2025 setting out details in relation to the proposed development of a Design and Innovation Hub at Nos. 35 – 39 Nicholas Street (a Proposed Protected Structure (Ref. No.: P.P.S. 2024/A)) to comprise artist studios, workspaces, retail area, exhibition space and café/restaurant with associated outdoor area adjoining St. Peter Street.

The development will include the erection of new part two storey, part single storey building incorporating the upstanding walls of the medieval house and their associated fabric and features at Nos. 36-39 Nicholas Street, the change of use from residential, refurbishment and renovation of No. 35 Nicholas Street, the demolition of a two storey extension to the rear and its replacement with a three storey extension, the erection of a single storey workshop unit to the rear of No. 35 and all associated site works. This development is within the site of Recorded Monuments, LI005-017006 and LI005-017123, both classified as House-medieval. The report had been prepared in accordance with Section 179(3)(a) of the Planning and Development Act 2000 (as amended) and Part 8 of the Planning and Development Regulations, 2001 (as amended) and noted that it was proposed to proceed in accordance with Section 8 of the report.

The Report, as circulated, was noted by the Elected Members.

(b) Addition to the Record of Protected Structures – Nos. 35–39 Nicholas Street, Limerick

Circulated, Report of the Director of Services, Planning and Place-Making dated 4th March, 2025 and enclosed Report of the Executive Architectural Conservation Officer dated 19th February, 2025 setting out details in relation to the proposed addition to the Record of Protected Structures maintained by Limerick City and County Council of Nos. 35-39 Nicholas Street, Limerick.

Proposed by: Councillor McSweeney;
Seconded by: Councillor Donoghue;
And Resolved:

“That, Nos. 35-39 Nicholas Street, Limerick be added to the Record of Protected Structures in accordance with the provisions of Sections 54 and 55 of the Planning and Development Act, 2000 (as amended)”.

QUESTIONS

6. Question submitted by Councillor J. Leddin

I will ask at the next Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick how many social, affordable and private housing units have been delivered in the Metropolitan District of Limerick to date, under our development plan housing targets, and how many units are expected to be delivered annually over the lifetime of the plan.

REPLY:

Table 1 below describes the total number of actual social, affordable and private housing units (Column B) that have been completed in the Metropolitan District of Limerick from 2022 to 2024.

The Development Plan housing targets (as described under the Development Plan's Housing Needs Demand Assessment) for each year from 2022 to 2028 are provided in column A below.

It is difficult to predict the overall expected number of units to be delivered in the Metropolitan District over the lifetime of the plan to 2028. However, the Housing Directorate has a clear live overview of the affordable and social housing pipeline up to 2028, as outlined in Columns C and D.

As of the end of January 2025, in Limerick City and Suburbs and Metropolitan Area, live planning permission is in place for 5,182 units and construction has commenced on 1,879 of these units since 2019. Permission is in place for 3,303 units, which have not yet commenced in the Metropolitan District.

Planning permissions exist but do not guarantee development completions. However, State subventions introduced in 2022 through the CREL/STAR schemes for cost-rental delivery and AHF/First Home scheme for affordable sale delivery are now starting to show results in delivery numbers in 2023 and 2024 within the Metropolitan District. See Column D.

	Limerick City and Metro Annual Targets as per Table 4.4 of HNDA of the Limerick Development Plan 2022-2028	Actual CSO Completions for Limerick City East, Limerick City West and Limerick City North (3 LEAs combined for Metropolitan District)	SOCIAL DELIVERY in Metro (New Build additional supply only - excludes renewals of existing units)	AFFORDABLE DELIVERY in Metro (New Build additional supply only - excludes renewals of existing units)	PRIVATE DELIVERY in Metro
	A	B	C	D	E
Data Source	https://www.limerick.ie/sites/default/files/media/documents/2022-07/Housing-Strategy-and-Housing-Need-Demand-Assessment.pdf	https://data.cso.ie/table/NDA05	DHLGH live TRABIS Tracker (internal database)	DHLGH live TRABIS Tracker (internal database)	No dataset available to determine private tenure. Private tenure assumed to be total CSO housing completions less social completions less affordable completions. B-(C+D)
2022	989*	500	277	0	223
2023	1976	564	230	63	271
2024	1976	748	255	104	389
2025	1976	Not known at this time	95 estimate	30 estimate	
2026	1976	Not known at this time	198 estimate	220 estimate	
2027	1976	Not known at this time	980 estimate	627 estimate	
2028*	989*	Not known at this time	286 estimate	177 estimate	

The figures in 2022 and 2028* represent their respective half years given the Development Plan period dates.

Table 1: Overview of Metropolitan District Delivery

7. Question submitted by Councillor J. Leddin

I will ask at the next Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick what progress is being made on the upgrade of the playground in Dooradoyle adjacent to the Crescent Shopping Centre in partnership with Clancourt Ltd.

REPLY: The Council has been in discussions with Clancourt Ltd in relation to an upgrade of the playground in Dooradoyle, in particular for inclusive play items. Clancourt Ltd have engaged with a playground company in relation to seeking cost estimates for the project and have advised that they received a cost estimate of €34,729.87 inclusive of VAT for a number of play items.

In order to progress the project further, Clancourt Ltd have requested financial assistance

up to a maximum of 50% from the Council. No funding source has been identified by the Council to date and once funding is secured, the project can be progressed further with Clancourt Ltd.

8. Question submitted by Councillor J. Leddin

I will ask at the next Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick for an update from the Council on their plans to resurface the main Greenfield Road in Rosbrien.

REPLY: Limerick City and County Council are liaising with Uisce Eireann to determine a solution and funding source to address road defects that have been caused by the previous installation of a watermain service at Greenfields, Rosbrien. Once agreed a road pavement repair and surfacing strategy for this area will be determined.

9. Question submitted by Councillor C. Slattery

I will ask at the next Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick can Limerick Council provide an update on what is happening with The Horizon Site Dublin Road. The site has been left derelict for years.

REPLY: I am pleased to confirm that the owners of the Horizon Mall site (Kirkland) are engaging with the local authority in relation to progressing their new masterplan for the development of the site.

It is hoped that the developer will complete this work soon and move on to preparing a planning application.

10. Question submitted by Councillor C. Slattery

I will ask at the next Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick can Limerick Council provide an update on what is the delay with Speakers Corner, these properties consisting of 36 units, 50% will be cost rental, 20 % age friendly, 30% social housing are much needed in Limerick.

REPLY: Speakers Corner consists of 19 cost rental units and 17 elderly/rightsizing units. The scheme is ready to start on site in the coming weeks. A Contractor has been appointed and have secured a compound close by. Funders are also on board to facilitate drawdowns. Expected completion is targeted for Q4 2026.

11. Question submitted by Councillor U. Gavan

I will ask at the next Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick can Limerick City and County Council return to lighting up King Johns Castle as it is widely well received and greatly enhanced the area from a tourist point of view.

REPLY: Lighting of the King John's Castle is currently set up and allowed for on the Castle Street side of the castle. Further plans to light up the castle are subject to detailed design and environmental sensitivity analysis and this is being considered by Discover Limerick DAC, as part of wider plans for the castle.

12. Question submitted by Councillor U. Gavan

I will ask at the next Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick what is the status of the dockless bike scheme for Castletroy/Annacotty and when will it be expanded beyond Castletroy to Corbally and Castleconnell.

REPLY: The dockless bike share pilot scheme which was operated by Tier-Dott concluded in December 2024. Tier-Dott have since ceased operations in Ireland.

The TFI Bike Share scheme operating across Limerick City is not affected by the conclusion of the pilot dockless scheme. The National Transport Authority has advised that the operation of the TFI Bike Share scheme is expected to be re-tendered later this year. Limerick City and County Council is working with the NTA to define an expanded geographical operating area for the TFI Bike Share scheme. We do not currently have a timeline for the roll out of the expanded scheme.

13. Question submitted by Councillor U. Gavan

I will ask at the next meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick, for an update on previous engagements that took place between Limerick City and County Council, Limerick Animal Welfare and local guards to crackdown on the numerous puppy farms located throughout the city and county.

REPLY: Under the Dog Breeding Establishments Act 2010, dog breeders are obliged to register their premises with the Council. The definition of a dog-breeding establishment under the Act is a premises where six or more breeding bitches are kept. Premises with less than six bitches are not obliged to register.

Complaints regarding illegal dog breeding establishments are investigated by the Dog Wardens, sometimes in conjunction with An Garda Síochána. Limerick Animal Welfare does not have a statutory role regarding this process.

Some complaints received by the Council do not result in enforcement actions because the premises are found to be already registered and have been inspected, or because there are fewer than six breeding bitches on site. Dog Wardens ensure that dog licences are in place, and, if not, issue the required Section 16 Notice.

The dog breeding establishment function of the Council is in the course of being taken over by the Department of Agriculture, Food and the Marine during 2025, and veterinary surgeons within the Department will be enforcing the Act when this transfer is complete.

14. Question submitted by Councillor S. Beasley

I will ask at the next Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick, how many over 55's are on the Limerick social housing list that have a disability.

REPLY: There are 322 people (identifying as Main Applicant) over 55 with a disability on the social housing waiting list. This figure covers Limerick City and County and includes those on the transfer list.

15. Question submitted by Councillor E. Secas

I will ask at the next Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick if a site has yet been identified for a community centre in Castletroy.

REPLY: Limerick City and County Council have committed to developing a strategy for community facilities based on the findings of the Community Facilities Audit already completed. The strategy will assist in the development of improved community infrastructure across the city and county. There is an awareness of the needs raised for the Castletroy area and this will be considered in the development of the strategy.

16. Question submitted by Councillor E. Secas

I will ask at the next Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick for a delivery timeline of the proposed new Park in the Groody area as part of the Green and Blue Infrastructure Strategy's implementation.

REPLY: There is currently no timeline for the delivery of a new Park in the Groody Valley. The purpose of specifically mentioning this particular green space in the Blue Green Infrastructure Strategy was to highlight its potential as a Park and to ensure that it is retained as a green space for recreational and ecological purposes, given its proximity to residential areas and the importance of green spaces for health and wellbeing.

The Council can consider the delivery of this project in due course and are cognisant of its delivery as part of other development plans for the area. There is currently no funding in place for the delivery of the project.

17. Question submitted by Councillor S. Kiely

I will ask at the next Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick what process took place to identify / assess the projects put forward for the Historic Structures Fund and what team / directorate executed this.

REPLY: The assessment of the Historic Structures Fund applications was carried out by members of the Public Realm and Heritage Team, within the Planning and Place-Making Directorate. The assessment panel consisted of:

- Maria Woods, Senior Planner
- Gráinne McMahon, Senior Executive Architect
- Shóna O’Keeffe, Executive Architectural Conservation Officer
- Nancy O’Neill, Assistant Architectural Conservation Officer

The assessment panel carried out a full review of each submission to ensure its eligibility in accordance with the Circular Guidance Document for the Historic Structures Fund and the panel visited each structure.

The panel carried out an assessment of each project against the criteria as set out in Section 4 of the guidance circular, issued by the Department of Housing, Local Government and Housing. These criteria are as follows:

- Significance of the Structure.
- Efficacy of the Grant in Achieving the Aims of the Historic Structures Fund.

- Quality of the Methodology and Technical Merit of the Works Proposed.
- Contribution of the Proposed Works to Keeping the Structure in Use, or Bringing it Back to Use.
- Broader public or community benefit of the project.

Each project was assigned a mark corresponding to how it addressed each of these criteria, and the top three scoring projects were recommended for submission to the Department of Housing, Local Government and Heritage. The recommendation was agreed by the Senior Management Team in advance of the letter issuing to the Department.

18. Question submitted by Councillor S. Kiely

I will ask at the next Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick for an update on the lighting of the railway bridge on Childers Road as it was to be completed in May 2025.

REPLY: Limerick City and County Council have recently completed repairs to the existing lighting infrastructure adjacent to the Childers Road Railway Bridge. The Public lighting team are also examining further additional lighting options which are dependent on approval from Irish Rail and funding availability.

19. Question submitted by Councillor S. Hickey-O'Mara

I will ask at the next Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick if this Council has a specific staff member who holds the title of 'horse warden'. If not, do they intend to fill this role. If there is not someone in this role locally, where does the licensed officer who fulfils this role for Limerick Council travel from.

REPLY: The LCCC Veterinary Services section has responsibility for enforcement of the Control of Horses Act 1996 and the Limerick City and County Council (Control of Horses) Bye Laws 2017. Section 3 of the Act allows the Council to appoint Authorised Persons who may exercise any of the functions conferred under this Act, such as the seizure of horses

The Council has privately contracted pound services provided by ACS, located in Cork, who are the appointed authorised officers for the Council. The LCCC Veterinary Services team work in close collaboration with An Garda Síochána and ACS in the carrying out Horse Control functions, responding to complaints, monitoring the green areas of the city, scheduling seizures and engaging with horse owners. The title of 'Horse Warden' is not a role set out under the Act.

20. Question submitted by Councillor S. Hickey-O'Mara

I will ask at the next Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick for this Council to please clarify which department has responsibility for the removal of dumped waste/litter from green spaces in the Metropolitan area.

REPLY: Any issues of illegal dumping should be referred to Customer Services and arrangements will be made for the removal of the waste/litter after investigations by the Litter Management section.

21. Question submitted by Councillor S. Hickey-O'Mara

I will ask at the next Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick for a timeline for the installation of automatic red-light cameras to monitor road users who break red lights throughout the Metropolitan area.

REPLY: The provision of static traffic light cameras and their implementation is a project under the supervision of the National Transport Authority.

At present there is no timeline regarding their implementation in the Metropolitan District of Limerick.

22. Question submitted by Councillor D. McSweeney

I will ask at the next meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick for an update on the proposed 24 units at Barnakyle, Patrickswell and in particular the request by the elected members whilst considering the Part 8 that 50% of these units be made available for purchase under the Affordable Purchase Scheme.

REPLY: The current unit mix for the Barnakyle development is as follows:

- 8 No. 2-bed units
- 11 No. 3-bed units
- 5 No. 4-bed units

In terms of project progress, the development is currently at Stage 3 under the Social Housing Capital Investment Scheme. Tender drawings were fully completed in September 2024, and we are presently awaiting the Connection Agreement for Uisce Éireann before advancing further.

A significant redesign was undertaken in March 2022, following initial approval of Stage 2 by the Department. This redesign was at the request of an Elected Member to incorporate provisions for elderly housing and homes suited for incremental purchase (starter home purchase scheme targeted at working HAP/RAS tenants). A revised Stage 2 submission was subsequently made and approved by the Department in July 2022. The Part 8 planning process commenced on 3rd September 2022.

We note from the minutes of the meeting where the Part 8 was decided a specific query seeking if Limerick City and County Council could apply to the Department of Housing to allow for 50% of this development to be designated as affordable funding for this scheme.

The Housing Construction Unit are advancing this project through the Social Housing Capital Investment Scheme. Should a review be undertaken to assess if 50% of the scheme would be considered eligible for the Affordable Housing Fund would require a number of checks:

- Eligibility check for Affordable Housing Fund (AHF) to meet a minimum of 15% reduction involving an independent all-in cost estimate alongside an independent valuation.

Should that check above be deemed positive, the following steps are required:

- Engagement internally and with the DHLGH on the matter to seek their advisory in the context of our suboptimal delivery of social housing against our targets
- Engagement with the Finance Section of LCCC to determine loan capacity
- Engagement with the Local Government Auditor

An assessment of this will be undertaken as soon as the Connection Agreement is secured. Elected Members will be updated in due course.

23. Question submitted by Councillor D. McSweeney

I will ask at the next meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick for an update in relation to the grass cutting along the N69 in Clarina Village for the coming year, and to include the roundabout in Clarina as part of this planned grass cutting.

REPLY: Limerick City and County Council will continue to carry out Grass and Hedge Cutting works along the N69 as per previous years. Limerick City and County Council are currently investigating options with TII to develop Clarina Roundabout under a proposed sponsorship scheme. We will continue to follow up on this and provide an update once available.

24. Question submitted by Councillor D. McSweeney

I will ask at the next meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick for a full itemised breakdown of expenditure already incurred in advancing the Wickham Street to Clare Street Active Travel Scheme to date.

REPLY: The expenditure to progress the Wickham St. to Clare St. Active Travel Scheme October 2020 to March 2025 is €207,577.62 (inclusive of VAT).

Breakdown as follows;

- Administration Costs €23.84
- Advertisement/Communication Fees €1,383.60
- Consultancy fees to advance to statutory process €90,054.45
- Economic Assessment €27,060.00
- Legal Fees €934.80
- Parking Survey €10,741.59
- Photomontages €200.00
- Photomontages- Virtual Room and Report €11,931.00
- Public Events €942.90
- Road Safety Audit €2,152.50
- Staff Salary and Costs €15,884.70
- Topographical Survey €30,550.00
- Traffic Modelling €15,718.24

NOTICES OF MOTION

With the permission of the Cathaoirleach, it was agreed to take Item No. 29 next.

29. Notice of Motion submitted by Councillor S. Hickey-O'Mara

I will move at the next Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick that this Council urge Limerick Libraries to adopt a home delivery service similar to that of other Local Authorities around the country for residents who are unable to visit their local library due to illness, reduced mobility or disability.

The Notice of Motion was proposed by Councillor Hickey-O'Mara, seconded by Councillor Donoghue and agreed.

In proposing the Motion, Councillor Hickey-O'Mara highlighted the possible benefits of a home delivery service and referred to a number of other Local Authorities in the country that were providing the service.

REPLY: Limerick City and County Library Service provides a comprehensive library service to urban and rural populations over an extensive geographic area. The service includes 16 no. Library Branches and a Mobile Library. This level of service compares favourably with other City and County Library services across the country.

In relation to residents who are unable to visit their local library we offer a "house bound service" from their nearest convenient library or mobile stop. When a person requests this service we ask them to nominate a friend or family member to collect their library items on their behalf. It is a practical, simple and cost effective solution to this demand.

At national level there is no one-size-fits-all approach to providing this service. Each Library Authority has adopted its own solutions to meet their specific requirements. The feedback nationally is that there is not a high level of expressed demand for a home delivery service. Our experience is that the current Limerick offer addresses the need for a house bound service for Limerick, within the library resources available.

25. Notice of Motion submitted by Councillor J. Leddin

I will move at the next Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick that the Council undertake a feasibility study on the Council owned site adjacent to Dooradoyle Mens Shed as suitable location for a community centre.

The Notice of Motion was proposed by Councillor Leddin, seconded by Councillor Donoghue and agreed.

In proposing the Motion, Councillor Leddin referred to the significant increase in population in the Raheen/Mungret/Dooradoyle areas, which has a mix of young families and elderly residents. He highlighted the need to provide a hub for educational, sporting and community groups to support the people living in those areas.

REPLY: The Council is currently looking at the best possible option for the Council owned site adjacent to the Men's Shed in Dooradoyle. If it is decided to make this available for a Community Centre it is at this stage a feasibility study will be undertaken.

Members welcomed the Motion but expressed concerns regarding the necessity of conducting another feasibility study for a community centre at this location.

In response to the members' concerns, the LCDC Chief Officer explained that a feasibility study is needed for the Council owned site under consideration as a potential location for the community centre, in order to assess its suitability.

26. Notice of Motion submitted by Councillor J. Leddin

I will move at the next Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick that the Council invite the Land Development Agency to a meeting to brief members on the several sites in the city awaiting housing planning applications in the city.

The Notice of Motion was proposed by Councillor Leddin, seconded by Councillor Secas and agreed.

Councillor Leddin welcomed the confirmation that the briefing had been scheduled for Monday, 7th April 2025. He highlighted the importance of the Land Development Agency providing a full update to Members on the timescale for delivery of housing on the key sites in the city, especially with the ongoing housing crisis

27. Notice of Motion submitted by Councillor U. Gavan

I will move at the next Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick that Limerick City and County Council engage with the Department of Housing to determine the status of the Tenant In Situ scheme, as the delays from the Department are causing unnecessary stress for landlords, tenants and Council officials.

The Notice of Motion was proposed by Councillor Gavan, seconded by Councillor Hickey-O'Mara and agreed.

In proposing the Motion, Councillor Gavan stated that confirmation of the allocated funding was urgently required, as applicants were waiting a long time for a decision on the scheme.

Members expressed support for the Motion, highlighting the success of the Tenant in Situ Scheme, and emphasised the need to engage with the Department of Housing, Local Government and Heritage to stress the urgency of providing a Scheme for 2025 to support those in need.

REPLY: We are engaging weekly with the Department of Housing, Local Government and Heritage (DHLGH) in relation to the status of the 2025 Tenant in Situ Scheme. We have outlined the urgency in providing a budget allocation for 2025 as we currently have a large number of acquisitions on hold. The DHLGH have stated that they are hoping to issue information on the 2025 targets in the coming weeks. We will continue to follow up until confirmation has been received and will keep Elected Members informed of the 2025 budget allocation and any specific conditions associated with it.

Administrative Officer, Housing Support Services agreed to update the Members on the outcome of an upcoming webinar organised by the Department of Housing, Local Government and Heritage.

28. Notice of Motion submitted by Councillor S. Beasley

I will move at the next Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick that Limerick City and County Council conduct an immediate Safety Audit of the Parkway Roundabout in Limerick.

The Notice of Motion was proposed by Councillor Beasley, seconded by Councillor Reale and agreed.

In proposing the Motion, Councillor Beasley highlighted the traffic volumes at the roundabout and the difficulties for pedestrians and cyclists. She referred to the importance of the junction for public transport and the need for a comprehensive traffic review at the location.

REPLY: Limerick City and County Council is planning to undertake a comprehensive safety review of several key junctions and roundabouts within the Limerick City area. This initiative spans multiple Directorates and Departments within the organisation and must align with the Council's travel and transport strategies. Notably, the Parkway roundabout will be included in this review.

Following discussions, it was agreed to provide the Elected Members with an update on the outcomes of the Parkway Roundabout review.

30. Notice of Motion submitted by Councillor S. Hickey-O'Mara

I will move at the next Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick that this Council ensures that all dogs rehomed directly from Limerick Dog Shelter are neutered or spayed before being released to their new owners.

The Notice of Motion was proposed by Councillor Hickey-O'Mara, seconded by Councillor Gavan and agreed.

In proposing the Motion, Councillor Hickey-O'Mara referred to the large percentage of dogs that were successfully moved to sanctuaries. For those that were rehomed directly, he highlighted the importance of neutering, which would prevent diseases and manage over population.

REPLY: Limerick Dog Shelter is maintained to accommodate dogs seized, accepted or detained under any of the provisions of the Control of Dogs Act. The Council operate the shelter under the functions of the Act in respect of the acceptance, detention, disposal and destruction of stray and unwanted dogs.

The Dog Shelter operates within the following principles;

That dogs are housed in the Dog Shelter appropriately and that staff monitor the welfare of any dogs being held in the shelter on an ongoing basis. That each animal has;

- A dry place to rest
- Access to fresh water and food.
- Adequate ventilation
- Adequate veterinary care
- The space necessary to assume normal postures such as lying, sitting, and standing.
- Protection from extreme weather whether hot or cold.

Stray dogs are kept in the Dog Pound for at least 5 days to allow the owner an opportunity to reclaim their dog. Once this period has elapsed, where the dog has not been reclaimed, it will be assessed by Council staff and will be rehomed or humanely euthanized. Dog shelter staff undertake to rehome suitable dogs as quickly as possible whether directly to the public or through charities.

Neutering or spaying requires a post-operative care period of 10-14 days following the procedure. During this time, animals should be monitored closely particularly in the 24 hour period following the operation and pain medication must be administered to the animal regularly. Post-operative animals would need separated from other dogs in the shelter to avoid the spread of infection. The cost of spaying and neutering varies between €200 and €400 depending on the weight of the dog. The Dog Shelter is not resourced to cover the cost of the procedures or to provide the level of post-operative care required. In addition, the current layout of the building and kennels would not accommodate this type of activity.

31. Notice of Motion submitted by Councillor E. Secas

I will move at the next Meeting of the Metropolitan District of Limerick that the Mayor and the Director General liaise with UL and An Garda Síochána, to set up and chair a taskforce to address car parking problems in residential areas around the University of Limerick.

The Notice of Motion was proposed by Councillor Secas, seconded by Councillor Doyle and agreed.

In proposing the Motion, Councillor Secas highlighted the severe parking issues in the residential areas around University of Limerick, which are causing difficulties for both residents and emergency services. She emphasised that the establishment of a task force would provide a forum for discussion and possible solutions.

REPLY: The University of Limerick (UL) community liaison group, which includes representatives from Limerick City and County Council (LCCC), An Garda Síochána (AGS), UL, and local residents, is actively seeking solutions to the ongoing parking issues. Despite the LCCC Traffic Warden issuing tickets, the problem persists.

Previously, LCCC and AGS led the "Think Before You Park" campaign, with AGS patrolling the areas last year. The parking problems are largely due to the high number of properties rented to multiple residents. While private student accommodations have started charging for parking permits, the public roads have limited capacity, and the demand for parking remains high.

The Mayor has indicated his willingness to meet the community liaison group and is looking forward to engaging with the Councillor on the matter.

This concluded the Meeting.

Signed: _____
CATHAOIRLEACH

Dated: _____